

Chocolate

For centuries, chocolate was a bitter drink, but it became a famously favored food when the ingredients were sweetened and solid chocolate was invented.

Nature's SWEETEST treat



Food of the gods

Chocolate has its roots in the cacao tree, *Theobroma cacao*. This Latin name means “**food of the gods**,” and the tree has long flourished in the hot climate of Central and South America. Inside each colorful fruit pod are sweet juice and **BITTER CACAO BEANS**—the essential ingredient of chocolate.

Ancient chocolatiers

Cacao beans were an integral part of ancient life in Mexico and Central America, making the **Inca, Aztec, and Maya peoples** the first true chocolatiers. They mixed cacao beans with spices to create a bitter drink called **chocolatl**, from which chocolate takes its name. Believing the beans had **MAGICAL PROPERTIES**, they used the drink in their sacred birth, marriage, and death rituals.

By the way...

I, Montezuma, emperor of the Aztecs, may have been one of the first chocoholics. Every day, I drank at least 50 cups of cacao from my golden chalice. Slurp!



It paved the way for...



Swiss chocolatier **DANIEL PETER** added condensed milk to the recipe in 1875 and invented **MILK CHOCOLATE** bars.



Fellow Swiss chocolatier **RODOLPHE LINDT** created the process of **CONCHING** in 1879, which produced smooth chocolate without the gritty texture it had previously.